

David brings the Ark to Jerusalem.

2 Samuel 6:1-19; 1 Chronicles 15:25—16:3

The Ark of the Covenant was a beautiful box God had told the Israelites to make from gold and wood. The Ark showed the people that God was always with them. Only the priests could carry the Ark. They used special poles, so they didn't touch the Ark itself. No one was to touch the Ark.

But the Ark had been left out in the country. Now that David was king, he wanted to bring the Ark to Jerusalem. David and some of his men put the Ark on a wagon that was pulled by oxen. They didn't carry it on poles as God had said to do. As they were walking, one of the oxen stumbled. A man touched the Ark to keep it from falling. When he touched the Ark, he fell to the ground dead.

Everyone was sad! Even though the man was trying to help, he had disobeyed God's command

not to touch the ark. David and his men left the Ark at a nearby house.

Later, David took his men and again went to bring the Ark to Jerusalem. This time they obeyed God's rules exactly. The priests carried the Ark on poles. King David led the big crowd of people. He sang and danced to show how glad he was that God was with His people. The people were singing and playing cymbals, harps and trumpets. Everyone wanted God to know how happy they were to have the Ark in Jerusalem!

When the Ark was safely placed in a special tent, David gave gifts to God and prayed. David finished the wonderful day of celebration by giving gifts to everyone who came to celebrate.